

BABS1201 Literature Review Instructions

A literature review is a descriptive summary of research on a topic that has previously been conducted. The purpose of a literature review is to summarise for readers the significant knowledge and ideas that have been established on a topic.

This assessment is designed to introduce you to the process of:

1. Navigating scientific literature
2. Differentiating between primary and secondary scientific literature
3. Communicating scientific literature to a different audience
4. Referencing scientific literature

This assessment is a “mini” literature review to assess your ability to identify, summarise and cite scientific literature – all skills you would use for an extensive review.

Due Date and Weighting

Your literature review is worth **25%** and is due **Friday Week 5, 5 pm** via the Turnitin submission box in the Assessments section of Moodle.

- You only get ONE submission. Please ensure you check the name of your file before uploading so that you upload the correct file. You should also check that you receive a receipt of submission, and you can click on your submission to see that it is displaying correctly for your marker.
- Please do not attempt to upload minutes prior to the deadline as, due to the number of students enrolled on the course, you WILL experience difficulties and may submit late.

Instructions

- Choose your topic from the topic list in the Assessment Hub of Moodle. This will be the topic for both your literature review (due Week 5) and the science communication assessment (due Week 9).
- The topic link will help your initial topic selection. You can choose to keep the topic as it is or you can refine the scope and focus, ensuring it remains connected to the topic and relates to at least one of the course themes (provided in the Assessments Hub on Moodle). If you decide to refine your focus, please consult your demonstrator in class to ensure it is well suited for this assessment.
- This assessment consists of two distinct components: the literature review itself and the research process you undertook to identify your chosen scientific articles. The research process should follow the reference section of your literature review in the document for submission.
- The maximum word count for the literature review and research process is 2000 words (not including the reference list). Additional words may not be read or marked.
- The literature review should use three peer-reviewed scientific articles (two primary articles and a review) related to your topic, and you will document the process you undertook to find and choose the articles in the research process section. You can use more articles if you prefer, but three is sufficient.

- You need to find scientific journal articles using a database, such as Google Scholar, as instructed in the course resources. A reminder that the popular science article linked to your topic is not scientific literature and is simply provided to help you select a topic!
- You will use the three articles to write a brief literature review, summarising the essential information and ideas from the research you have found on your topic. A reminder, the target audience for this piece of writing is your BABS1201 peers, this requires a different writing style to the scientific articles you are using.
- It is highly recommended that you listen to the lecture on Scientific Literature, complete the related online lesson on Scientific Literature, listen to the Science Communication 1 lecture on the Literature Review Assessment and use the BABS1201 Library Tutorial to assist you. These can all be found on our Moodle page. The UNSW library will also conduct a live Tutorial and Q&A on Teams.

Criteria: Mini Literature Review

Your mini literature review will be assessed on the following criteria, which are included in the marking rubric found in the Assessments section of Moodle:

1. **Introduce the topic.** Use an informative title that communicates the focus of the review. Include an introduction that provides background information to contextualise the topic and outlines the structure of the review that follows.
2. **Content.** Using your scientific articles, articulate the main points clearly & interpret the content of the sources to develop a logical review of the topic area.
3. **Conclusion.** A succinct statement based on your review of the literature. Superior responses will synthesise the information from the articles to give new insights and conclusions or suggest future directions.
4. **Readability.** The structure is well organised and logical, with clear breaks yet logical connections between introduction, body paragraphs, and conclusion. The writing style is appropriate for a BABS1201 level audience. Adheres to the word limit.
5. **References.** Peer-reviewed references include at least two primary journal articles and one secondary article/review. Reference list and in-text references are formatted correctly, using Harvard style (there is a module on Harvard referencing on Moodle).
6. **Research process.**
 - **Relate to course themes.** Clearly state how your topic choice and the refined scope and focus relates to the course themes.
 - **Article selection and information.** State which of your articles are primary and which is a secondary review article. You only need to discuss the three required articles in your research process, even if you used more in your literature review. You will need to provide information on each article including the journal and publication year. These will need to be referenced correctly in text in this section as well.
 - **Choice of articles.** Describe why you chose each of your articles and why they were relevant to your topic.
 - **Primary and Secondary literature.** Describe the differences between primary and secondary articles and how you confirmed you chose these correctly.
 - **Documentation process.** For each article, describe the database and search you performed to identify it. You need to provide all necessary information such as the keywords, phrases, how you confirmed your articles were peer-reviewed and other criteria employed during the search. You will also need to include any limitations or filters you applied to refine the search. You do not need to include screenshots but can provide information on the results such as how many articles you narrowed the search to.

References

You must reference the articles that you refer to at the end of your literature review using Harvard style. A module on how to reference scientific articles correctly is available on Moodle, this explains how to use in-text citations and format references. Further information is here:

<https://student.unsw.edu.au/referencing>

Word count

The word count is 2000, therefore your assignment MUST NOT exceed this limit. You will not be penalised for being under the word count but do ensure it is of sufficient length to address the criteria. The word count excludes the reference section but includes the title, any subheadings, the research process and in-text citations. You must perform a word count and indicate the count at the beginning of your literature review.

Plagiarism

Please revise the information on academic integrity and plagiarism here before commencing your literature review: <https://student.unsw.edu.au/plagiarism>

Tip: Plagiarism does not simply mean you must reference your sources. It means that your assignment must be *written in your own words*. For help on using your own words and style in academic writing see <https://www.student.unsw.edu.au/intellectual-insecurity>. Please contact Academic Skills if you require advice on using your own words and developing your own style: <https://www.student.unsw.edu.au/skills>

Generative AI

You can use generative AI software in this assessment for assistance in summarising your journal articles from the more technical language used in scientific literature. This may assist you in seeing how scientific literature can be communicated in simpler language suitable for a different audience. Any output of generative software within your assessment must be attributed with full referencing.

If the outputs of generative AI such as ChatGPT form part of your submission and is not appropriately attributed, it will be regarded as serious academic misconduct and subject to the standard penalties, which may include 00FL, suspension and exclusion.

* To cite: OpenAI (Year Accessed). ChatGPT. OpenAI. <https://openai.com/models/chatgpt/>

* Please note that the outputs from these tools are not always accurate, appropriate, nor properly referenced. You should ensure that you have moderated and critically evaluated the outputs from generative AI tools such as ChatGPT before submission and keep a record of this for if you are required to show the process you used.

An AI fundamental training module is recommended as a course activity prior to the literature review assessment. This can be accessed via the "AI" menu at the topmost of the Moodle page and selecting "Be Ready with Generative AI" or you can also find the module in the Week 3 section of the BABS1201 Moodle page.

Learning Outcomes

- The literature review assesses some of the learning outcomes from the Scientific Literature lecture and associated online lesson, develops some UNSW Graduate Attributes and addresses the Science Threshold Learning Outcome 4.1 communication (<https://www.acds.edu.au/teaching-learning/science-threshold-learning-outcomes->

[tlos/science-tlos/](https://tlos.science-tlos/)).

- CLO 1: Effectively communicate scientific findings to different audiences using different methods.

Resources provided

Resources provided to help you with this assessment include:

- The 'Scientific Literature' lecture.
- The 'Scientific literature' lesson (Moodle).
- The BABS1201 Library Tutorial, how to find scientific journal articles (Moodle).
- The 'How to search for journal articles' lesson (Moodle).
- The 'How to reference using the Harvard style' lesson (Moodle).
- The Science Communication 1: Literature Review Assessment Lecture

Frequently Asked Questions

What does my mini literature review focus on?

You will choose a topic from the topic list provided in the assessment section of Moodle. Read the popular science article linked to the topic to find out more about the area. You may then refine the scope of your literature review – what is it you want to focus on? For example, if your topic was on vaccines you may choose to compare the different types of vaccines or focus just on mRNA vaccines. Outline what you will cover in your introduction and discuss with your demonstrator in class if you have any questions.

Does my refined topic need to relate to all the course themes?

No, your topic only needs to relate to at least one of the course themes (but can relate to more than one).

Do I write about each article separately in my mini literature review?

You do not need to write about each article separately. You should read the relevant parts of each article and become familiar with the topic. You can then write on the topic as outlined in your introduction, keeping the style appropriate for a BABS1201 audience, while referencing the information from your articles. We recommend that you find a review first (check the lecture and lesson on Scientific Literature for what a review is), and this will give you an example of how to integrate the articles. However, remember that you are writing to a different audience.

Would I be able to reference sections from a book?

Yes, you absolutely can use other types of references such as books, remember you also need to include one review and two primary research journal articles.

Can I use a systematic review or other types of reviews for the literature review assignment?

No, for this assessment, you must use a traditional narrative review article, not a systematic review, meta-analysis, or any other type of review. A narrative review provides a broad, qualitative overview of the literature on a specific topic, whereas a systematic review rigorously gathers and critically evaluates all relevant studies on a particular research question. We require narrative reviews because they align with the course objectives. Please ensure your selected review article meets this requirement. If you're unsure whether your chosen article qualifies, feel free to ask your demonstrator for confirmation.

Is the title page/ title/ in-text referencing counted in the word count?

The title is included in the word count, as is in-text referencing. Turnitin will only exclude the

bibliography/reference list when it also does a word count check. There is no need to include a title page, we realise this is specified in some disciplines, but it is not required for this assessment.

What kind of language do I use in the literature review?

We are happy for you to use either first- or third-person language for this task. Early science writing was in the first person and very descriptive, later science came to be more in the third person and written very concise. This was in part to make it easier to follow (like a recipe book rather than a food blog!) and the conciseness also came as journals started to charge for the number of pages that your article takes up when published.

Unfortunately, we are now in a place where only scientists often understand science papers. But there is a movement to make science writing more readable. While some courses will ask you to focus on practicing writing in a scientific style (formal & third person), we are more interested in students being able to communicate science in 'normal' language. Simply ensure you answer the marking criteria.

How do I structure my mini literature review?

For our mini literature review you should begin with an introduction, then the body of the review should be made up of sections that focus on one idea or aspect of your overall topic. In these sections you should group similar studies together, summarising the main points of each study. Conclude your review by highlighting the key ideas and insights you discovered. Connect these insights to show their broader significance in the academic or real-world context. Remember to cite your sources correctly throughout.

There are many ways to structure an actual literature review. For this assessment, we recommend this simplified structure to help you focus on developing key skills. These skills include navigating scientific literature effectively, distinguishing between primary and secondary scientific sources, communicating complex scientific ideas to a different audience, and referencing scientific literature. Talk to your demonstrator if you would like to use a different structure for your mini literature review.

Example structure of a mini literature review on vaccines

Introduction:

- Briefly introduce the importance of vaccines in public health.
- State the purpose of your mini literature review – e.g., to explore key findings and insights related to vaccine efficacy and public perception.

Section 1: Vaccine Efficacy Studies:

- Group together studies that specifically address the efficacy of vaccines.
- Summarise the main findings of each study regarding how well vaccines work in preventing diseases.

Section 2: Public Perception of Vaccines:

- Group studies that explore public attitudes and beliefs about vaccines.
- Summarise the main points regarding public acceptance, concerns, and factors influencing vaccine hesitancy.

Conclusion:

- Highlight key takeaways from both sections.
- Discuss the broader significance of the collective information, emphasising the role of vaccine efficacy and public perception in shaping effective vaccination programs.
- Conclude with a call to action or areas for further research if applicable.

Need more help?

Ask questions on the forum, in your laboratory class and in the course Q&A sessions. You may also contact the Feedback Hub if you would like feedback on your drafts:

<https://www.student.unsw.edu.au/feedback-hub>